

Self-Talk for Kids

E-GUIDE



Helping kids build more

Calm

Courage

Self Love

&

Joy



WELCOME! WE'RE SO GLAD YOU'RE HERE!

We are a husband and wife team who struggled with our son's emotional journey for years. We tried everything possible to help him find more joy and our family find more calm.

We finally tried self-talk and within 10 days everything shifted. Less anxiety, improved mood, more cooperation and most importantly more JOY! It felt like magic, but as an Occupational Therapist I knew it was neuroscience at work. So we made Daily Power Up! a self-talk app for kids, to help other families experience the relief and positive changes that we did.

This E-Guide contains the information you need to help your child create more calm, courage, self love and joy and we're honored to share it with you! Let's get started!

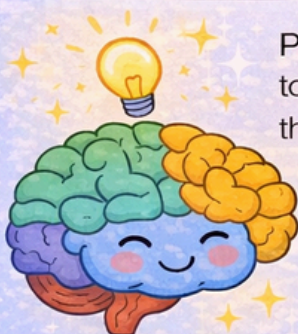
What is Self-Talk?

Your child is always talking to themselves – even when you can't hear it. That quiet inner voice is their self-talk, and it's built from the words they hear and say every day. This inner voice starts forming as early as age two and quietly shapes how they see themselves. By age **five**, many children are already labeling themselves as “good” or “bad.” When a child's self-talk becomes harsh or negative, big feelings can feel even bigger and harder to manage. They may:

React	Avoid	Self Blame
Defiance Anger Meltdowns No Cooperation	Anxiety Withdrawal Resist change Rigid routines	Depression Negative self image Difficult peer/family relationships

For children with negative self-talk, every day situations can feel like a threat:

- Playing with a friend means they could get teased.
- Learning to ride a bike may bring feelings of failure.
- Losing a game feels like they're not good enough.



Positive self-talk re-wires the brain (we'll get to the science in a bit!) replacing negative thought patterns with calmer, confident & more joyful thoughts. This leads to better stress management, emotional health and behaviors.

The Daily Role of Self-Talk

Self-talk plays a constant role in your child's daily life. From the time they wake up until the time they go to bed their inner voice is coaching them through the day. Children, much like adults, use self-talk to:

- Narrate what's happening.
- Predict what comes next.
- Decide if a situation feels safe or overwhelming.
- Label events as positive or negative.
- Reinforce their self-worth as good or bad.

Self-Talk is the Brains Instruction Guide:

Self-talk isn't "extra" - it's essential. Our brain uses the words we speak and think as an instruction guide to decide what actions to take - or behavior to produce.

Here's the cool part

By changing your words you can change the action or behavior the brain chooses.

Change the words



Change the instructions



Change the behavior



Neuroscience in a nutshell -

You might be wondering – how can self-talk cause the brain to act a certain way?! **Here is the science** behind what happens in the brain when **your child** hears or speaks self-talk on **repeat** –



When children face **big emotions** and challenges their inner voice determines which part of their brain will activate: **The amygdala** or the **frontal lobe**.



1. The Amygdala

Your child's **emotional brain** automatic survival instincts

- Built-in alarm system
- Fight, Flight,
- Freeze

Triggers when your child feels stressed or unsafe, causing hearts to race, muscles to tense, and behaviors like running away, screaming, hitting, or shutting down.



2. The Frontal Lobe

The thinking part of the brain **logic & self-control**

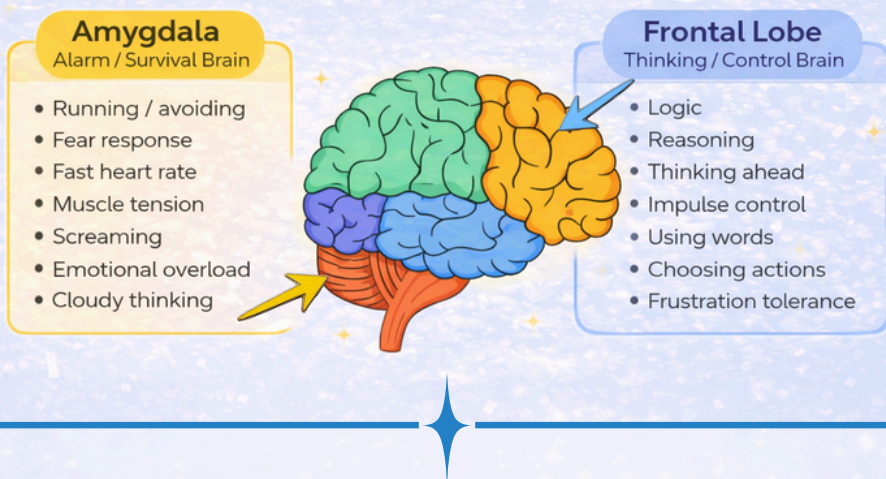
- Responsible for logic, problem-solving, following directions
- Goes **offline** when the amygdala kicks in.



When the amygdala is in charge...

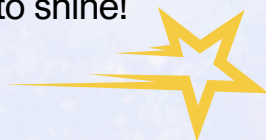
- The **thinking part of your child's brain** (frontal lobe) goes **OFFLINE**.
- The frontal lobe is responsible for logic, problem-solving, and frustration. When it's offline, it's harder for your child to stay calm or think through their reactions.

Two Brain Systems at Play



When the amygdala is in charge a child who is avoiding, melting down, acting out physically, screaming or escaping can't respond to strategies that seem like they should work like: repeating directions, using reasoning or lectures, consequences in the moment or asking questions. First you must turn down the amygdala's alarm system and activate the frontal lobe - so kids can think, choose, and cope instead of shutting down.

Self-talk is a quick, simple and easy tool that shuts down the amygdala and strengthens the frontal lobe. Now let's explore where the science of self-talk really starts to shine!



How Self-Talk Rewires the Brain

Each time a positive self-talk phrase is repeated, it builds a neural pathway (a route that messages travel along in the brain). The more often that phrase is practiced, the stronger and easier that pathway becomes. Over time, the strongest pathways turn into the brain's default instructions, shaping how a child thinks, responds, and behaves.

Daily Power Up! uses the power of positive self-talk to strengthen the neural pathways to the frontal lobe so calm, reason and joy can be your child's strongest pathways.

Imagine this:



Neural pathways are like hiking trails through a forest. The paths you walk most often become clear, wide, and easy to follow. Trails that are rarely used slowly become overgrown and harder to find.

The words your child hears and repeats act the same way. Thoughts and phrases practiced again and again keep those pathways strong and accessible. When kids are on purpose about choosing hopeful and supportive language it builds pathways that lead to calmer emotions and happier kids.

"How To" Self-Talk

Step 1 -

Download Daily Power Up! and let our guided process help you navigate through **6 self-talk categories made just for kids:**



School



Anxiety



Body Image



Building Resilience



Sports



Self-confidence

Choose affirmations that flip your child's biggest challenges into positive self-talk statements. There's no right or wrong way to choose your self-talk list. The best affirmations are the ones that make you smile or feel a little stronger when you read them.

Choose as many or as few as you'd like and update or change your affirmations anytime. It's not about how many you listen to, the key to success is just listening every day! Consistency is key to rewiring the brain.

Create multiple profiles for different family members, moods, goals or seasons of life.

Self-Talk in Action

Affirmation

I can try new things.

I'm excited to take on any challenge.

I am perfectly made.

I don't need everything to be perfect to be ok.

I can do hard things.

I am a great listener.

I grow more confident every day.

Behavior

More flexibility

More cooperation

Improved self-esteem

More frustration tolerance

Perseverance

Follows directions better

Less Anxiety

"How To" Self-Talk

Step 2 -

Press play and go about your day. The key to success with self-talk is consistency. Hearing the phrases on repeat is essential to make the new neural pathways strong. But as parent's we know it can feel hard to fit one more thing into your routine.

The great news is that Daily Power Up! makes it easy to press play and listen while you go about your normal routine. **No need to "find time" to fit in self-talk.** Play your affirmations in the background while the kids play, eat a snack, brush teeth, get shoes on for the bus stop or on a drive.



Don't force your child to repeat the words. Just press play. If they talk over it – that's ok. Ignore it – that's ok. Simply hearing the words, even in the background, even if they are interrupted, will begin to rewire the brain. If your child yells, screams, covers their ears or runs away - that's normal! That's the old negative self-talk pushing back. **Check out our FAQ's** for an in depth look at how to get your child to buy into self-talk for faster results!

"How To" Self-Talk

Step 3 -

Listen every day. Set an alarm and make it part of your daily routine. Skipping days slows progress; staying consistent creates faster, lasting results. Listen for as long or as little as you'd like!

We recommend 3 minutes a day, but even a few seconds a day can start to rewire the brain for more calm, courage and joy.



Join in the fun. Modeling self-talk for your child isn't "putting on a show" - it's normalizing kindness toward ourselves. When kids see you using supportive language (and even enjoying it), they're far more likely to join in.

If you notice your own negative self-talk pushing back name it out loud and talk about it together. These moments help your child learn that everyone has an inner voice - and we get to choose how we respond to it.

Check out our FAQs for a deeper look at how to talk with your child about self-talk!

When You'll See Results



Fully replacing negative self-talk can take time, sometimes up to **30 days** or more. The most negative thought patterns can be stubborn. But it typically doesn't take that long.



The brain doesn't wait that long to **start changing**.

Research on neuroplasticity shows that after hearing **positive self-talk** consistently for just a few days, the brain begins forming new pathways.



Parents tell us (and we **experienced this with our son**), that mood and behavior shifts often show up within **7-10 days**, **with better** choices and noticeably less stress by two weeks.



How to know if it's working

Watch for signs – a breath before a reaction, a calmer response to a challenge, a surprisingly easy exit out of the house and into the car. If something feels different, easier or kinder than usual and you've been listening to positive self-talk it's not a coincidence. It's the brain rewiring itself.

As you continue to watch and listen, self-talk in action will become easier and more obvious to spot. Your child may recover faster from a meltdown or shockingly skip it all together, they may offer an affirmation as advice to a sibling or friend, or mutter an encouraging word to themselves as they work through a challenge.

Self-talk is proven neuroscience and **it will work** if you are consistent with it. You will see positive results and they will grow stronger the longer you practice.



Final Thoughts

Now you know the basics of what self-talk is and how it works. That means **you now have a powerful way to support your child** – not by fixing them, but by helping them strengthen the inner voice they carry with them everywhere. That matters and we are honored to support you.

Thank you for doing the brave, meaningful work of helping your child become their best self. You've found a community that believes in you and your child.

Welcome to Daily Power Up!

Check out our blogs for more Pro Tips:

- If Negative Self-Talk Fights Back, You're Doing It Right.
- Self-Talk That Fits Into Real Life: No Extra Time, Big Rewards.
- Less Resistance, Faster Results: Helping Kids Buy Into Self-Talk.
- Repeating Affirmations or Just Listening – Does It Matter?
- Do We Have to Do Self-Talk Forever?



Let's Connect!



We're on this journey of children's mental wellness along side of you and we would love to connect!

Tell us your story, ask a question or suggest an app improvement!



Daily Power Up



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